Kayoon Kim

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RESEARCH INTEREST

Human-AI Interaction, AI Evaluation, Social Intelligence, Responsible AI

EDUCATION

University of Tübingen Tübingen, Germany 2023–2026
M.S., Quantitative Data Science (*Concentration*: Machine Learning), GPA 1.88/1.0

Chung-Ang University Seoul, South Korea 2017–2023
B.A. B.E., Sociology & Computer Science, GPA 4.13/4.5 & 3.96/4.5

PUBLICATIONS

Kim, K. 2027. Scaffold or Social? What Survives When LLM Agents Negotiate a Shared Physical Space. *In preparation,* In *ACL 2027*.

Kim, K.; Brendel, W.[†]; and Reizinger, P.[†] 2026. HALLMARK: How to Diagnose LLM Citation Verifiers and When to Deploy Them. *Under review,* In *ICLR 2027*.

Kim, K.; and Suh, C. S. 2024. Mobilizing Grievances in the Internet Age: The Case of National Online Petitioning in South Korea, 2017–2022. *PLOS ONE*, 19(5): e0302373.

POSTERS

Belz, J. H.[*]; **Kim, K.**[*]; Rukzio, E.; and Grosse-Puppendahl, T. 2026. Sim-DSE: Mediating Multi-User Automations in Cars through Simulation-Augmented Decision Space Exploration. In *AutomotiveUI 2026 Adjunct* (Works in Progress), 94–99.

Kim, K. 2021. Claiming for Rights: The Changing Landscape of Issues and Claims in the National Petition of South Korea, 2017–2020. Poster presented at the International Postgraduate and Academic Conference, co-hosted by Chung-Ang University, Ritsumeikan University, and National Taipei University.

[*]Equal contribution [†]Equal advising

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Assistant, Max Planck Institute & ELLIS Institute Tübingen 2026
- In the Robust Machine Learning group, built HALLMARK, a benchmark of 2,526 real and hallucinated citations, to diagnose LLM citation verifiers
- Designed controlled experiments isolating three verifier failure modes across 7 model families; derived deployment guidance for when verifiers can be trusted

Research Intern, Porsche Human-Centered AI Research 2025–2026
- Built a multi-agent LLM simulation of multi-occupant car decisions, validated against a survey of 100 participants; mapped the decision space into design guidelines
- Fine-tuned an LLM for an in-vehicle field test in three stages: supervised fine-tuning, Chain of Hindsight, and KTO on binary human feedback

Research Intern, Bosch Research (BCAI) 2024
- Developed Preferential Bayesian Optimization algorithms to optimize machinery settings by modeling expert human preferences
- Conducted synthetic bias experiments to identify cognitive biases and developed mitigation strategies for human-in-the-loop experimental design

Research Assistant, Methods Center 2023–2024

- Developed a state-based model (Kalman Filter) using students' psychological data to predict dropouts in STEM fields, enhancing educational environments

Research Assistant, Da Move Lab 2020–2023

- Constructed and analyzed dataset of South Korea's online petitions revealing embedded biases through text mining and NLP techniques
- Applied fine-tuned language model for sentiment analysis and regression modeling to identify structural limitations in civic engagement platforms

Research Assistant, HIKE Lab 2020–2021

- COVID-19: Our Memory: Identified pandemic-driven social inequalities via text mining and statistical analysis; awarded Community Award among 320 participants
- Assessed policy efficacy, enhanced data visualization and presented at Open Data Day Seoul 2021; donated to the National Library of Korea as the first case of a non-governmental digital archive

WORK EXPERIENCE

Data Quality Manager Intern, Kakao Style, South Korea 2023

- Designed and developed an automatic labeling model that streamlined the review text labeling processes, reducing manual effort by over 50%
- Analyzed model prediction data and developed dashboards to enhance model accuracy and user experience

HONORS & GRANTS

DAAD STIBET Scholarship, German Academic Exchange Service (DAAD) 2025
Research Stipend, Porsche AG 2025–2026
Research Grant, National Research Foundation of Korea 2024
Merit-and-need-based Scholarship, Seoul Scholarship Foundation 2022
Merit-and-need-based Scholarship, Lotte Scholarship Foundation 2021
Community Award, Ministry of the Interior and Safety, South Korea 2020
National Scholarship, Korea Student Aid Foundation 2017–2021

SERVICE

Reviewer
Interactive Media Experiences (IMX) 2026

Organization
Participant, EAAMO Urban Data Science Working Group 2025–2026
Communication Chair Volunteer, Tübingen Women in Machine Learning 2025
Content Creator Volunteer, Soapbox Science Tübingen 2025
Guest Speaker, Introduction to Sociology, Chung-Ang University 2022
Academic Advisor, COSADAMA 2020–2021

SKILLS

Language English (Full professional proficiency), Korean (Native)
Methods
Experimental design, LLM evaluation, Preference learning, Survey design, NLP
Programming and Development
Python, R, PyTorch, BoTorch, LLM APIs, AutoGen, SQL, Git, Linux